

El Moussaddar, J., Belfakir, L., Tadist, K., Habiballah, S., & Bellet, M. (2025). The impact of social interaction on students' satisfaction with synchronous online learning at FLDM. Social Sciences & Humanities Open, 12,9,101759

Lack of face-to-face interaction in online education settings

Zhaxygulov Alimkhan
260225@astanait.edu.kz



Problem + Research Purpose

Research purpose

- To examine how social interaction affects students' satisfaction with synchronous online learning.
- Focus on instructor–student and student–student interaction.

Background

- *Online learning can make communication and social connection more difficult.
- *Students may experience isolation, distractions, and technical problems.
- *The researchers wanted to understand whether better interaction could improve students' online learning experience.



Methodology

Participants: Graduate students from the English Studies

Department. **University:** Sidi Mohamed Ben Abdellah University, Fez, Morocco.

Participants: 52 students Research method: **Mixed methods** – quantitative + qualitative. **Data collection:** Online questionnaire + follow-up semi-structured interviews. **Questionnaire period:** December 2022 – January 2023. Interviews: 20 students. **Data analysis:** SPSS + Pearson correlation. **Qualitative analysis:** Coding and thematic analysis



Three Key Findings

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1. Instructor–student interaction

- Better communication with instructors was associated with higher satisfaction.
- Students valued responsive teachers and opportunities to participate.

2. Student–student interaction

- Communication between students also improved the online learning experience.
- Cooperation and informal interaction helped students feel more connected.

3. Sense of community

- A stronger sense of community was linked to greater satisfaction.
- Statistic: $r = 0.701, p < 0.001$
- Students with a stronger sense of community were more likely to recommend online classes.

Why it matters

- The results show that online learning is not only about technology – social connection also affects students' satisfaction.



Personal Reflection + Recommendation

Personal Reflection + Recommendation

What I learned

- Online learning depends not only on technology, but also on communication.
- Good interaction can make students feel more engaged and connected.

Most interesting finding

- I found the connection between the sense of community and satisfaction most interesting.
- Even when students study online, they still need communication and social interaction.

Connection to IT

- As an IT student, I may work with remote teams and online communication tools in the future.
- Understanding how people interact online can help create better digital learning and collaboration systems.

Recommendation

- Combine online learning with opportunities for live communication, discussion, and collaboration.



Conclusion

Social interaction plays an important role in students' satisfaction with synchronous online learning.

The study shows that communication between students and teachers can improve the learning experience and reduce feelings of isolation.

However, online learning may also create problems such as distractions, limited communication and technical difficulties.

Overall, combining online learning with face-to-face interaction can provide a better balance between flexibility and social connection.



References

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